

You can visit the project homepage at <http://winpooch.free.fr/page/home.php?lang=en&page=home> .

Winpooch is ClamWin-based, and is cited as an efficient anti-spyware and anti-Trojan package. Its strength lies in providing protection by scanning in real-time, what we earlier called on-access scanning. For the nerds, it is coded in C and extensively uses API hooking. Winpooch provides a powerful control mechanism to the user so that any suspicious activity can be tracked. You may catch a rodent trying to nibble at your Registry bits or making attempts at quaffing your Internet bandwidth. On the downside, it is limited to the 32-bit architecture and so Poochy, the lively spyware buster, will not be able to use his firearms on other maps.

8.2.1.1 How does it differ?

Winpooch differs from “just another anti-spyware software”: it sniffs like a watchdog. While others rely heavily on spyware signatures, often limited to a database, our candidate watches programs for suspicious actions using a set of filters. ClamWin and Winpooch can provide a perfect open source security combo. Also, solutions from Kaspersky and BitDefender AV are compatible with it. This might save you good bucks if you are crying over how Ad-Aware SE could have solved the needs of mankind with its paid “plus” package. As most security software do, Winpooch slows down your computer to some extent. However, care has been taken to forgo time-critical functions, that is, those functions that need immediate servicing from the OS and cannot wait for a prolonged period of time. This ensures that the system runs smoothly.

8.2.1.2 Installation and setting up

Start with the installer, which is a little over 1 MB. It is recommended to run Winpooch after a new OS installation, as it necessarily protects and does not destroy existing spyware.

After installation, Winpooch will offer to download the anti-virus updates. Choose Update and proceed to finish the setup. It is advisable to restart the machine. Winpooch will start on bootup,